

**Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts**

**Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole**

May 16, 2013

7:00 p.m.

**Superintendent's Conference Room
Medford High School**

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 p.m. in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School by Vice Chairperson John Falco.

All rose to salute the flag.

The following members were in attendance Ann Marie Cugno, George Scarpelli and Paulette Van der Kloot. 4 present 3 absent.

Also present: Superintendent Roy Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Director of Technology Richard Trotta, Network Administrator Allan Arena, Director of Science/Mathematics Carolyn Joy, Director of Administration and Finance Ann Giombetti, Coordinator of Occupational Therapy/Assistive Technology Jan Hollenbeck, and High School Librarian Maria D'Orsi.

Chairperson Falco stated that the purpose of the meeting was to receive pre budget reports from the technology and science departments. Mr. Falco then called upon Superintendent Belson to provide an overview to the specific reports.

Superintendent Belson explained that each report would be in two parts. The first part would be an update on the major projects underway (Tech Plan and Science Labs). The second part would be the actual budget FY13 recap and FY14 projections.

Please find attached the full reports of each department.

Mr. Trotta began with the technology report. He was joined by Ms. Hollenbeck, Ms. D'Orsi and Mr. Arena during the report. Each addressed areas that are specific to their respective work.

The following are the key points of the technology report:

1. The major Tech Plan has been implemented and is 95% complete.
2. The iPad initiative is underway and professional development for functional use is in place. Applications for classroom use will be the next wave that will begin next fall.

3. The permanent air conditioning of the Head-end room will not be complete until the summer. The Head-end rooms are located at the McGlynn and the high school.
4. The cost of the air conditioning is uncertain pending bids. It is higher than previously anticipated and it means that some hardware, software, and training must wait. It is possible that there could be some residual funding left over to restore some of the original items including computer carts.
5. The universal access (sped) roll out is going well. Student utilization must be carefully done so that shared applications do not breach confidentiality and/or scheduled use.
6. More training is a priority since the use of this new system is a major paradigm shift for all involved.
7. The library program needs a new circulation system installed for next year. More access to computers in the libraries has been a major plus.
8. The enhanced use of *Moodle* has great potential for classroom instruction and as an alternative to new textbook acquisition.
9. The network traffic has increased exponentially. There are many more devices on the system than ever before and it is growing. The use of personal devices is accommodated but it requires greater bandwidth.
10. Next year's budget will require an investment of at least \$250,000 new funding to preserve and operate the network and address instructional needs. If major new hardware is added than that number will grow.
11. LanDesk is a promising new software package that can reduce some personnel needs. It is an improvement to Alteris software. It can re-image multiple computer devices on a remote basis. We will be using LanDesk next year.

Carolyn Joy then updated the Committee on science matters. The following are the highlights of her report:

1. The Science Lab Project is going well and is on schedule. There are regular meetings with the architects, project managers, administration, faculty and staff.
2. Faculty classroom re-location is underway and there is sufficient space to accommodate all. Use of two vocational labs is planned.
3. Chemical management is in place with the assistance of the E.P.A. at no cost to the city.
4. Parking plans are nearly in place and a couple of options are being considered.
5. Demolition will begin on July 8, 2013 with lab completion projected for April 2014,
6. New state determined science curriculum is being developed and we need to wait until these documents emerge before buying any substantial number of texts.
7. Excellent professional development activities are occurring through various programs at both the high school and middle school levels.
8. It is requested that a technology/engineering teacher be hired for the McGlynn to mirror the program at the Andrews.
9. Administrative help is also required for the science department given the major project underway and the new evaluation system.
10. Additional safety training should be envisioned as we move to the new labs.

11. The department is working on the high school accreditation.
12. There should be a new emphasis on robotics.

There was substantial discussion throughout both presentations.

The meeting was adjourned at 9:20 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,

John Falco
Vice Chairperson